

# Rory Harder

[roryharder@gmail.com](mailto:roryharder@gmail.com) & [www.roryharder.com](http://www.roryharder.com)

AOS Philosophy of Mind, Philosophy of Language  
AOC Epistemology, Logic, History of Philosophy (early analytic, early modern)

## Employment

2025–2027 POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW, Collège de France  
*Project:* Mental Files: New Foundations, *Principal Investigator:* François Recanati  
2023–2025 POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW, University College Dublin  
*Project:* Institution and Conversation, *Principal Investigator:* Elmar Unnsteinsson  
2022–2023 ASSISTANT PROFESSOR (part-time, teaching stream), University of Toronto  
2019–2020 SESSIONAL LECTURER, Rutgers University

## Education

2015–2022 PHD in Philosophy, University of Toronto  
*Dissertation Title:* Joint Action and Communication, with a Focus on Demonstratives  
*Committee:* Imogen Dickie (co-supervisor), Nate Charlow (co-supervisor), Phil Kremer, David Barnett (internal examiner), Guy Longworth (external examiner)  
2019 VISITING STUDENT in Linguistics, Rutgers University, *Host Supervisor:* Simon Charlow  
2011–2015 BA (HONS) with High Distinction in Philosophy (Specialist) and History and Philosophy of Science and Technology (Minor), University of Toronto

## Papers

### PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

2025 Knowledge-First Mentalizing: Concept-Based or Merely State-Based?  
*Synthese*, <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11229-025-05213-1>  
2023 Clearing up Clouds: Underspecification in Demonstrative Communication  
*Canadian Journal of Philosophy*, <https://doi.org/10.1017/can.2023.26>  
2022 Joint Attention and Communication  
*Inquiry*, <https://10.1080/0020174X.2022.2074101>

### PUBLIC PHILOSOPHY

2025 Nietzsche on Justice  
*Washington University Review of Philosophy*, <https://doi.org/10.5840/wurop2025410>

### IN PROGRESS

[A paper on speech acts], *Revised & Resubmitted*  
[A paper on the metasemantics of demonstratives], *Under Review*  
[A paper on the formal semantics of demonstratives], *Under Review*  
[A paper on the formal semantics of deictic features], *Manuscript in Preparation*  
[A paper on copredication], *Manuscript in Preparation*

## Presentations

- 2026 Demonstratives Contribute Conventional Implicatures, *Philosophy of Language and Mind Network Conference* (Spain) & *European Society for Philosophy and Psychology Meeting* (NL)
- 2025 Act and Speech Act, *French Society for Analytic Philosophy Congress* (France)
- 2024 Knowledge-First Mindreading and Epistemology, *Joint Session of the Aristotelian Society and the Mind Association Open Session* (UK)
- A Non-Ideal Theory of Speech Acts, *Genre and Conversation Workshop* (Iceland) & *Interpretivism, Mental Fictionalism, and Folk Psychology Workshop* (Estonia)
- 2022 Updates Beyond Semantics and Pragmatics, *Context, Cognition, and Communication Conference* (Poland)
- 2021 Joint Attention: The Window Into Other Minds?, *APA Pacific Symposium Session* (USA)
- Joint Attention and Communication, *Mutual Knowledge 40 Workshop* (UK)
- A Puzzle About Demonstrative Understanding, *The Seventh International Conference on Philosophy of Language and Linguistics* (Poland)
- 2020 The Grammar of Reference, *New York Philosophy of Language Workshop* (USA)
- Perspectives in Demonstrative Semantics, *Szklarska Poreba Workshop* (Poland)
- 2019 Clearing up Clouds, *APA Pacific Colloquium Session* (USA)
- 2018 Clearing up Clouds, *Context, Cognition, and Communication Conference* (Poland)
- 2017 Inferences and Neutrality of the Deliberative Ought, *APA Pacific Colloquium Session* (USA) & *Canadian Philosophical Association Meeting* (Canada)

## Teaching

### COURSES TAUGHT AS INSTRUCTOR WITH SOLE RESPONSIBILITY AT THE UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

- 2023 PHLA10: Reason and Truth (1st year)
- PHLB58: Reasoning under Uncertainty (2nd year)
- PHLD87: Advanced Seminar in Philosophy of Mind: Perception and Conception (4th year)
- 2022 PHLC95: Topics in the Philosophy of Mind: Animal Minds (3rd year)
- PHL100: Introduction to Philosophy: Historical (1st year)
- 2020 PHL390: Special Topics in Philosophy: Frege's Puzzle (3rd year, online)
- 2019 PHL340: Issues in Philosophy of Mind: Perception and Conception (3rd year)

### COURSES TAUGHT AS INSTRUCTOR WITH SOLE RESPONSIBILITY AT RUTGERS UNIVERSITY

- 2020 PHL109: Introduction to Formal Reasoning and Decision Making (1st year, online)
- 2019 PHL109: Introduction to Formal Reasoning and Decision Making (1st year)

### TUTORIAL TEACHING & GRADING AT THE UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO

- 2013–2021 PHL200: Ancient Philosophy (2nd year), PHL210: 17th- and 18th-Century Philosophy (2nd year), PHL232: Knowledge and Reality (2nd year), PHL100: Introduction to Philosophy (1st year), PHL245: Introduction to Symbolic Logic (2nd year, online), PHL246: Probability and Inductive Logic (2nd year)

### OTHER

- 2021–2022 Super-TA for the Socrates Project (Supervising Undergraduate TAs, University of Toronto)
- 2016–2018 Philosophy Don (Tutor and Residence Assistant, Trinity College, University of Toronto)

## Grants

- 2023–2025 IRC Postdoctoral Fellowship (€105,604)  
*Awarded annually, by the government of Ireland, to about 12% of applicants.*
- 2016–2019 SSHRC Joseph-Armand Bombardier Doctoral Scholarship (\$105,000CAD)  
*Awarded annually, by the government of Canada, to about 22% of applicants.*

## Service

- 2026 ASSISTANT EDITOR of the Mental Files PhilPapers category
- 2025 CHAIR at APA Eastern and International Social Ontology Society Conference
- 2024 CO-ORGANIZER of two philosophy of language workshops at University College Dublin
- 2023 COMMENTATOR at APA Eastern and Canadian Philosophical Association Annual Meeting,  
JUDGE at Ontario High School Ethics Bowl
- 2022 CHAIR at APA Pacific
- 2020 GRADUATE STUDENT COORDINATOR for an institutional strategic initiative in language and cognition at University of Toronto
- Refereeing *The Journal of Philosophy, Philosophical Studies, Synthese, Philosophers' Imprint, Canadian Journal of Philosophy, Erkenntnis, Journal of the American Philosophical Association, Topoi, Philosophical Explorations, Czech Academy of Sciences*

## References

- Research IMOGEN DICKIE, Professor, Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto  
*Contact:* [Imogen.Dickie@utoronto.ca](mailto:Imogen.Dickie@utoronto.ca)
- NATE CHARLOW, Associate Professor, Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto  
*Contact:* [Nate.Charlow@utoronto.ca](mailto:Nate.Charlow@utoronto.ca)
- ELMAR UNNSTEINSSON, Assistant Professor, School of Philosophy, University College Dublin  
*Contact:* [Elmar.Unnsteinsson@ucd.ie](mailto:Elmar.Unnsteinsson@ucd.ie)
- Teaching RACHEL BARNEY, Professor, Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto  
*Contact:* [Rachel.Barney@utoronto.ca](mailto:Rachel.Barney@utoronto.ca)